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THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 6, 2025

Audacious Gaza idea has officials scrambling

President gave own team little warning about his proposal for US involvement

By Jonathan Swan and Maggie Haberman
NEW YORK TIMES

When President Trump on Tuesday announced his proposal for the United States to take ownership of

the Gaza Strip, he shocked even senior members of his own White House and government.

While his announcement looked formal and thought-out — he read the plan from a sheet of paper — his

administration had not done even the most basic planning to examine the feasibility of the idea, according to four people with knowledge of the discussions, who were not authorized to speak publicly.

It wasn't only the Americans who were scrambling; the announcement came as just as much of a surprise to Trump's Israeli visi-

tors. Soon before they walked out for their joint news conference Tuesday, Trump surprised Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel by telling him he planned to announce the Gaza ownership idea, according to two people briefed on their interactions.

Inside the US government, there

MIDEAST, Page A10

Comments stun local supporters of both sides

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

Provocative comments this week from President Trump about the United States taking ownership of the future of the Gaza Strip were met with horror and concern by people in the Boston area with Mideast connections, with many saying the idea is outlandish, threatens a fragile cease-fire, and would undermine Palestinian self-determination.

"It's really just insanely ridiculous," said Michael Maria, a 50-year-old Palestinian American from Roslindale.

And, Rabbi Toba Spitzer, of the Congregation Dorshei Tzedek in Newton, called Trump's proposal "horrificing," saying "it's offensive to even suggest that the Gazan people will be displaced."

"The reaction both from American Jewish groups, from our allies, from Arab nations, from the Palestinian leadership makes it clear that this is a non-starter," she said. "I join others in wondering if this is serious or not because it's so far-fetched."

Although members of his administration are already walking back portions of Trump's remarks, the president's controversial statement Tuesday night that the US would redevelop the war-torn territory, displacing some 2 million Palestinians in the process, continued to reverberate around the world. He proposed the US turn Gaza into "the Riviera of the Middle East," describing its current state as a "big pile of rubble" after the 15-month war between Israel and Hamas, and perhaps would even deploy American troops there.

REACTION, Page A10



ABDEL KAREEM HANA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A man sold bread Wednesday under what was left of his bakery in Jabalia on the Gaza Strip.

Mass. tourism may pay price for Canadian anger

By Christopher Muther
GLOBE STAFF

Over the weekend, Canadian Prime Minister Justin Trudeau told Canadians to reevaluate their US vacation plans after the Trump administration threatened the country with a hefty 25 percent tariff. The tariff has been paused for 30 days, but the damage may already be done.

"Now is the time to choose Canada," Trudeau said at a press conference in Ottawa. "It might mean changing your summer vacation plans to stay here in Canada and explore the many national and provincial parks, historical sites, and tourist destinations our great country has to offer."

Even before Trudeau called on Canadians to travel domestically, some had already begun canceling their US vacations and using social media to express their anger.

CANADA, Page A7

On sidelines

An executive order barred transgender student-athletes from women's sports. **A6.**

On notice

The US attorney pledged to prosecute local officials who obstruct efforts to arrest immigrants. **B1.**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Jilda A. Casillo joined an anti-Trump State House rally Wednesday. **B2.**

Funding chaos casts cloud on low-income solar plans

By Sabrina Shankman and Erin Douglas
GLOBE STAFF

It was supposed to be a great equalizer: a federal program that would put solar panels on 900,000 rooftops in low-income and disadvantaged communities around the country, ensuring that everyone could be part of the clean energy transition.

But now, just weeks into the Trump administration, the \$7 billion Solar for All program — an effort run by the Environmental Protection Agency — is effectively on hold, as

awardees who have received federal grants find themselves locked out of an online platform to access the funds.

It is, by all accounts, a chaotic situation. Through executive orders and a separate memo, President Trump has attempted to halt funding for a host of federal grants and loans, including for clean energy to combat climate change. But last week, two judges temporarily blocked those attempts in response to lawsuits brought by a nonprofit coalition and a group of

SOLAR, Page A7

A painful slide effect

Thursday: Snow, sleet, slush. High 33-38, low 31-36.

Friday: Clearing, windy.

Weather, **D6.** Obituaries, **C8-9.**

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House leaders sought to patch the state's emergency shelter system by dramatically limiting the number of families. **B1.**

The local figure skating community has quickly organized ways to support the families of the victims in the Washington, D.C., plane disaster. **C1.**

Gillette has launched a search for a new location for its headquarters near its longtime home in South Boston. **D1.**

Gun enthusiasts find camaraderie and tips through YouTube channels. **A2.**

Aga Khan IV has died. The leader of the world's Ismaili Muslims was 88. **C9.**

A mayoral race built on housing

From day one, Wu and Kraft draw lines on key issue

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

In a campaign launch video posted to YouTube Monday, a simple slogan appears just below Josh Kraft's name. "More housing. More opportunity."

And at the formal launch of his mayoral campaign Tuesday at Prince Hall in Dorchester, Kraft — the longtime nonprofit leader and son of billionaire Patriots owner Robert Kraft — doubled down, attacking Mayor Michelle Wu's record on housing while unveiling a rent control proposal of his own and promising to increase the production of homes.

"On the number one challenge facing our residents, access to housing

that regular people can afford, production under Mayor Wu has ground to a dead halt," Kraft said. "I know it's a complex problem, but at its core, you can't solve a housing crisis if you're building less of it."

In the first 24 hours of his campaign, Kraft has made it clear: This year's mayor's race will largely center on housing.

It is a fitting hook for the contest to

KRAFT, Page B3

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